

Data leak worksheet

Incident summary: A sales manager shared access to a folder of internal-only documents with their team during a meeting. The folder contained files associated with a new product that has not been publicly announced. It also included customer analytics and promotional materials. After the meeting, the manager did not revoke access to the internal folder, but warned the team to wait for approval before sharing the promotional materials with others.

During a video call with a business partner, a member of the sales team forgot the warning from their manager. The sales representative intended to share a link to the promotional materials so that the business partner could circulate the materials to their customers. However, the sales representative accidentally shared a link to the internal folder instead. Later, the business partner posted the link on their company's social media page assuming that it was the promotional materials.

Control	Least privilege
Issue(s)	<i>Access to the internal folder was not revoked from the employees resulting in the accidental sharing of the link to the folder containing confidential information.</i>
Review	<i>NIST SP 800-53: Control AC-6 addresses Least Privilege. The manager should ensure that users, processes, and devices are granted only the minimum access rights and permissions needed to perform their authorized functions.</i>
Recommendation(s)	• Automatically revoke access to information after a period of time. • Regularly audit user privileges.

Justification	<i>These will limit users to only the access they need, reducing unauthorized access and misuse of sensitive information. Regularly reviewing and monitoring can also identify excessive privileges and potential abuse, improving overall system security.</i>
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